

their players had the best chance at winning. They even set up a temporary bootcamp in Singapore so that their players could be closer to the



servers and have better ping in the qualifiers. No doubt that must've cost them a lot of money. Unfortunately, their star player, SkRossi, who is prone to migraines had one of his worst attacks in the duration they were there and GE were not able to perform at the top of their game despite all their efforts.

This time around as well, we saw Velocity and Global eSports both qualify for the VCT qualifiers but GE were beaten twice and dropped out of the qualifiers and the same thing happened with Velocity Gaming a few days ago.

Even though we may have lost in the qualifiers, it didn't stop the world from noticing what India has to offer as Rossi became a fan favourite across the world with his amazing no scope shots in the first APAC Last Chance Qualifier on the map of Haven. It is because of talents such as him that the Indian teams are starting to get the respect they deserve in the international level even though we see them choking against teams they should have been able to beat pretty easily but that's an issue we hope to see the teams overcome in the future considering that we are fairly new to huge international competitions going mainstream in India hence increasing the popularity of the players and orgs along with the pressure on them to perform well so as to not disappoint their fans.

It's not all about the players though, we have seen major organi-



sations come up and make a name for themselves in the tournament organising space. Organisations such as The Esports Club and Sky eSports came into Valorant and have become huge in the market today.

Sky eSports have tournament after tournament happening and each of them now having a huge prize pool of at least USD 10,000 and not just that, they were also the first to take an innovative approach to the way we host and watch tournaments. They introduced the premier league format in a tournament that they hosted. The teams were all based on different locations in India and each of them were given a budget to spend on players that they could spend. The auctions included two kinds of players, the first one being professional players who were parts of various organisations and the other type being content creators and streamers. Each team bought an amalgamation of both and the tournament format turned out to be a huge success. Though Sky eSports is yet to have another such tournament, we still look forward to it as such tournaments bring to light the

potential a few players could have if they were playing on the same team. While on the other hand, The Esports Club, or TEC for short, have developed what is now one of the biggest valorant tournaments in the country. The TEC Gauntlet, which is a gauntlet format tournament spans for a long time giving people a constant source of valorant action between the top teams in the country. It also boasts a huge prize pool and it is divided amongst the top 6 teams which makes it THE tournament to be a part of for a new up and coming team.

WHAT WE EXPECT TO SEE IN THE FUTURE

While there is a clear skill difference between the Indian teams and the ones they face off against in the VCT, we are seeing constant improvement in our representatives and that is what matters as of now. As each year passes, we also see major changes being made in the scene as Global eSports are looking to maybe make a few roster changes and Velocity Gaming having a strict 4 year plan as their owner, VLT Sentinel, aims to leave the esports market after that period of time.

The players may become free agents or the entire roster might be picked up by another organisation. Either way, it will be a bidding war on them if Sentinel does indeed decide to stop all operations in the esports field once his 4 year plan comes to an end. What might come out of that event? Well, we'll see great IGLs like Amaterasu becoming a free agent and even though him and the other players from VLT might decide to band together, let's not cross out the possibility that they will be separated by being bought out by other orgs and said other orgs might just end up building rosters that represent the APAC region in the Valorant Challengers Tour.

Having an Indian team representing the region would surely be a sight for sore eyes and would no doubt help in the growth of esports in the country even further. *

